

DIVERSITY AND PHARMACOLOGICAL CLASSIFICATION OF HOMEOPATHIC MEDICINES: A REVIEW OF NATURAL AND ENERGETIC SOURCES

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RESUME

Homeopathy employs a wide spectrum of medicinal substances derived from plant, mineral, animal, biological, and non-material origins. This review systematically analyzes the six principal categories of homeopathic medicines – botanical, mineral, animal, sarcodes, nosodes, and imponderabilia. Approximately 60% of remedies originate from plants and 20% from mineral sources [7], while the remainder includes animal-derived substances, healthy tissues, pathological materials, and energetic preparations. Each category demonstrates distinct therapeutic tendencies, ranging from acute symptom relief to chronic constitutional treatment. Although homeopathy remains widely utilized globally, its mechanisms of action remain debated due to ultra-high dilutions. This paper provides a structured synthesis of remedy sources while highlighting areas requiring further scientific validation.

ჰომეოპათიური პრეპარატების
მრავალფეროვნება და ფარმაკოლოგიური
კლასიფიკაცია: ბუნებრივი და
ენერგეტიკული წყაროების მიმოხილვა

ნინო ყურაშვილი

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რეზიუმე

ჰომეოპათია იყენებს სამკურნალო ნივთიერებების ფართო სპექტრს, რომლებიც მიღებულია მცენარეული, მინერალური, ცხოველური, ბიოლოგიური და არამატერიალური წარმოშობის წყაროებიდან. მოცემული მიმოხილვა სისტემურად აანალიზებს ჰომეოპათიური პრეპარატების ექვს ძირითად კატეგორიას – ბოტანიკურ, მინერალურ, ცხოველურ, სარკოდებს, ნოსოდებს და იმპონდერაბილებს. დაახლოებით 60% პრეპარატებისა მცენარეული წარმოშობისაა, ხოლო 20% მინერალური წყაროებიდან მომდინარეობს, მათგან დანარჩენი ნაწილი მოიცავს ცხოველურ წარმოშობის ნივთიერებებს, ჯანმრთელი ქსოვილების ექსტრაქტებს, პათოლოგიურ მასალებსა და ენერგეტიკულ პრე-

პარატებს. თითოეული კატეგორია ხასიათდება განსხვავებული თერაპიული მიმართულებებით, რომლებიც მერყეობს მწვავე სიმპტომების შემსუბუქებიდან ქრონიკული კონსტიტუციური მკურნალობის ჩათვლით. მიუხედავად იმისა, რომ ჰომეოპათია ფართოდ გამოიყენება გლობალურად, მისი მოქმედების მექანიზმები კვლავ სადავოა ულტრამალალი განზავებების გამო. წინამდებარე ნაშრომი წარმოადგენს პრეპარატების წყაროების სტრუქტურირებულ სინთეზს და ხაზს უსვამს იმ სფეროებს, რომლებიც საჭიროებს შემდგომ სამეცნიერო ვალიდაციას.

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Homeopathy, introduced by Samuel Hahnemann in the late 18th century, is based on the principle of similarity (*similia similibus curentur*) and potentization [1]. Over time, the homeopathic materia medica has expanded to include more than 2000 remedies derived from diverse origins. The classification of remedies into six major categories – plant, mineral, animal, sarcodes, nosodes, and imponderabilia – provides a framework for understanding their therapeutic applications [2,4]. These categories reflect both material and conceptual domains, including biological regulation and energetic influence [7]. Despite its widespread use, homeopathy remains controversial within modern medicine due to the lack of consistent evidence beyond placebo effects [6,7]. Nevertheless, its individualized therapeutic approach continues to support its global use.

This study is a qualitative review based on educational lecture material [7], classical homeopathic literature [1–4], and Critical and supportive scientific analyses [6,7].

Each category was analyzed according to origin, preparation, characteristics, and clinical application.

Sources of homeopathic remedies are as follow:

1. Plant Kingdom (Botanical Sources)

Plant-derived remedies constitute approximately 60% of homeopathic medicines [7].

They are typically prepared from whole plants or specific parts such as leaves, roots, flowers, and seeds.

Characteristics of homeopathic remedies prepared from botanicals are:

- Rapid onset of action
- Predominantly used in acute conditions
- Strong influence on emotional states [2,3]

Belladonna is one of the homeopathic remedies prepared from *Atropa belladonna* (whole plant / berries / leaf / root) and is used in high fevers, inflammation, and throbbing pain [2]. It contains toxic alkaloids: atropine, scopolamine, hyoscyamine and therefore, a very dangerous raw. Stemmed from above mentioned, this material must be handled only by trained practitioners.



Figure 1. *Atropa belladonna*



Figure 2. *Aconitum napellus*

Next well known remedy prepared from botanicals is *Aconitum napellus* extracted from Monkshood, and that is rich in highly toxic diterpenoid alkaloids, primarily aconitine, mesaconitine, hyaconitine, and jesaconitine. *Aconitum napellus* is used in sudden fevers, acute shock and fear [3]. Poisonous plants, before using is homeopathic remedies, are rendered safe through potentization [1].

2. Mineral Kingdom

Approximately 20% of homeopathic remedies are derived from mineral sources [7]. These include metals, salts, and acids, which are potentized to reduce toxicity.

Characteristics of homeopathic remedies prepared from minerals are:

- Deep and long-lasting action
- Used in chronic and structural disorders [3]

For example, *Calcarea carbonica* (Calcium carbonate, CaCO_3)– obtained from Oyster shells is used in growth issues, anxiety, and fatigue, and metabolic disorders [2]. *Natrum muriaticum* (Sodium Chloride, NaCl) is used in emotional disturbances [2], and *Sulphur* (Elemental sulfur, S) is used in dermatological conditions [3]

3. Animal Kingdom

Few homeopathic medicines are prepared from certain animal products; However, **without killing** animals.

These homeopathic preparations are mostly their venoms, secretions, and tissues.

Homeopathic remedies prepared from animal sources:

- Have intense and dynamic action
- Affect neurological and hormonal systems [2]

One of the effective homeopathic remedies prepared from animal sources, *Apis mellifica*, a venom of honeybee is used for **swelling, stinging pain, and** allergic reactions [2].



Figure 3. *Apis mellifica* – homeopathic remedy prepared from honeybee venom.

Venom from *Lachesis muta*, derived from bushmaster acts at a **deep psychological level** to manage the complaint of **depression and schizophrenia**. It also works on blood vessels where it helps **control bleeding**. It also helps to **improve blood circulation** and offers help in **treating varicose veins** and **varicose ulcers**. [3]

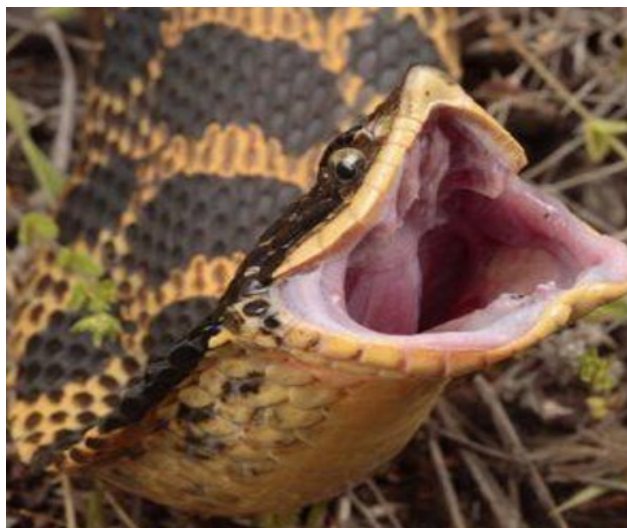


Figure 4. *Lachesis muta* venom is used in homeopathic remedies

Sepia (or *Sepia officinalis*) is a well-known, frequently used remedy in homeopathy. It is derived from the ink of the cuttlefish and is primarily used for issues related to hormonal imbalances, emotional exhaustion, fatigue, and various gynecological or menopausal symptoms. [2]



Figure 5. The cuttlefish and its ink

4. Sarcodes

Sarcodes are prepared from healthy tissues or secretions (e.g. hormones, organs). They are used to support

Thyroidinum, an extract from healthy thyroid gland is used in thyroid dysfunction, hypothyroidism, fatigue, and obesity. *Adrenalinum*, hormonal secretion, supports adrenal fatigue or stress-related disorders and



Figure 6. Thyroidinum, Adrenalinum, Pancreatinum in pharmaceutical forms

Pancreatinum, prepared from pancreas, aids digestive disorders and diabetes

5. Nosodes

Some homeopathic medicines are prepared **using tissues or secretions** containing bacteria, viruses, and **other microorganisms** Homeopathy advocated the **therapeutic use of miniscule amounts of microorganisms** long before the introduction of vaccines.

Nosodes are derived from diseased tissues or pathogens [4,5].

They are used primarily in chronic conditions and are believed to stimulate immune responses **or clear inherited disease patterns** [4]. For example: *Tuberculinum* **from tubercular tissue** is used in **chronic respiratory issues and inherited weaknesses**; *Medorrhinum*, from gonorrheal discharge is used in deep-seated chronic conditions, anxiety, and *Psorinum* prepared from **from scabies** is **used in extreme skin**

conditions, chronic weakness, and despair.

Preparation of nosodes involves dilution and potentization to eliminate toxicity [1].

6. Imponderabilia

Imponderabilia are derived from non-material sources such as radiation, light, and magnetism.

They act on energetic or “vital” levels and are used in complex or modern disorders [7]. For **Example:**

X-ray (X-rayum), prepared from exposure to X-rays is used in radiation effects and deep disturbances;

Magnetis polus australis prepared from the South Pole of a magnet influences polarity and vitality;

Sol is made by sunlight and used for sun sensitivity and seasonal affective disorder and finally,

Electricitas prepared from electric current is successfully used for nerve complaints, sensitivity, and electromagnetic disturbances.

Category	Source	Typical Use
Mineral	Elements, salts, acids	Chronic illnesses and structural disorders
Plant	Herbs, roots, flowers	Acute conditions, fever, emotional states
Animal	Venoms, secretions	High intensity conditions, hormonal imbalance, emotional volatility
Sarcodes	Healthy organ tissues	Organ support, endocrine and glandular disorders
Nosodes	Diseased tissues / pathogens	Chronic miasms, inherited and deep-seated disorders
Imponderabilia	Energies, light, radiation	Functional disturbances of energetic or unexplained origin

TO SUMMARIZE:

The classification of homeopathic remedies into six categories reflects a comprehensive therapeutic system integrating physical and energetic concepts [2,8].

- Plant remedies primarily address acute conditions
- Mineral remedies target chronic structural diseases
- Animal remedies act dynamically on emotional and hormonal systems
- Sarcodes and nosodes relate to physiological and pathological regulation
- Imponderabilia extend treatment to energetic domains

The concept of potentization is central to all categories but remains scientifically controversial [1,6]. High dilutions often exceed Avogadro's limit, raising questions about mechanism of action [6].

Systematic reviews suggest that many observed effects may be attributable to placebo responses [5], though alternative hypotheses such as water memory and nanostructures have been proposed [6].

Homeopathic medicines are derived from a diverse range of sources, each contributing unique therapeutic

properties. The six-category classification provides a structured understanding of remedy origins and applications.

Despite historical and clinical use, further high-quality scientific research is required to validate efficacy and clarify mechanisms [6,7].

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